

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 552

By Haile

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Susan O. Binns of Nashville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Susan O. Binns; and

WHEREAS, Susan Binns was an extraordinary individual whose life was marked by compassion, determination, and an unwavering commitment to helping others; and

WHEREAS, she was among the first women to receive a scholarship to Cumberland Heights in 1979, beginning her own journey in recovery and immediately dedicating her life to supporting others, eventually earning her licensed alcohol and drug abuse counselor certification in 1990 and helping to start thirteen addiction care and recovery housing programs in Nashville; and

WHEREAS, a devoted advocate for recovery and ethical standards in addiction treatment, Ms. Binns was a pioneer in the field, founding YANA (You Are Never Alone) in 1996, one of Nashville's first recovery housing communities for women, and offering holistic, trauma-informed care well before those principles became standard; and

WHEREAS, in 2008, Susan Binns founded the Tennessee Alliance of Recovery Residences, the State's first self-governing recovery housing organization, in response to the need for safe transitional housing identified by the late Judge Seth Norman; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Binns served as national president of the Association of Halfway House Alcoholism Programs and helped lead its evolution into the National Alliance for Recovery Residences (NARR) in 2011, now a national standard-setting body representing over 8,000 recovery homes, including nearly 300 in Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, her work has been recognized by the Substance Abuse and Mental Health Services Administration, the American Society of Addiction Medicine, and the National Council for Mental Wellbeing, all of which now affirm the core practices Susan Binns championed; and

WHEREAS, a recipient of multiple honors, including the 2024 Lifetime Achievement Award from the Tennessee Association for Addiction Professionals, Ms. Binns also mentored numerous leaders in the recovery community, including Trina Frierson, founder of Mending Hearts, and many others who credit her with shaping their path and purpose; and

WHEREAS, Susan Binns was known for her tireless advocacy, her deep understanding of trauma and recovery, her willingness to be vulnerable with those she served, and her unmatched sense of humor, which brought laughter and healing into the spaces she helped create; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Binns leaves behind her loving children, Chandelle C. Binns and John J. Binns, and a host of friends, colleagues, and those in recovery who will long cherish her memory and the lives she changed; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of Susan Binns, a woman whose tireless work on behalf of people from all walks of life helped foster dignity, healing, and opportunity across this State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Susan O. Binns, reflecting fondly upon her impeccable character and her stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Ms. Binns.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.